

Ian Cowpar

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SUMMARY

Senior product manager who builds AI capability functions from zero inside enterprise software. Specialized in turning ambiguous, undefined problems into shipped platform tooling — by writing the prototype myself, defining the measurement model, and removing engineering as the bottleneck. Two years operating at principal scope at UKG; a decade prior in compliance-grade financial services at Broadridge. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework with weekly published thought leadership on AI adoption realism. Known for opinionated data products that route a decision rather than display one — and for adoption that holds because nobody had to order it.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager · UKG · Lowell, MA · Jun 2024 – Apr 2026

\$250M ARR enterprise platform program · Internal tooling, AI capability, and 0→1 product

- **Built the product organization's first organized AI capability layer**, scaling shared infrastructure that 20 PMs adopted and sustained without top-down mandate — by designing for org-wide reuse from day one, running the founding peer group, and coaching individual PMs into role-specific use cases.
- **Shipped a 0→1 self-serve migration product from idea to production in a one-week prototype cycle**, removing engineering from the critical path of a previously ticket-gated enterprise workflow — by personally writing the working prototype in Claude Code, decomposing scope across three business epics (UI, rules, deployment), and delivering an engineering-ready package (epics, stories, sequencing, roadmap) the platform architect built against.
- **Designed an opinionated operational analytics product that cut a working defect list from ~200 issues to 5 (~97% reduction)**, so engineering triaged signal not noise — by classifying open issues across five panels (customer escalations, code defects, internal bugs, CVEs, noise) across four products and embedding a Claude Code function that surfaced the single highest-leverage action per panel.
- **Built a composite ARR-risk model for the top 10 accounts in the enterprise upgrade program**, replacing raw ticket counts with a defensible signal that surfaced aging risk before escalation — by scoring exposure, case volume, true-defect signal, and Salesforce sentiment into a weekly automated metric the program lead acted on.
- **Influenced cross-functional prioritization across product, engineering, and services without direct authority** in executive escalation rooms, synthesizing what 300 enterprise customers (\$250M ARR) actually needed against what was committed and translating that into tradeoff decisions.
- **Designed delivery-health instrumentation refreshing every 15 minutes** across two engineering teams, with documented rejection criteria for burndown, velocity, and story-point anti-patterns — process governance built for signal, not ceremony.

Brand Champion, UKG North America Regional Lead 2026 · Fire Up ERG (women and allies), Business Innovation workstream lead

Business Analyst · Broadridge Financial Solutions · Andover, MA · Jan 2014 – Jun 2024

- **Led 40+ enterprise client deployments end-to-end in a compliance-grade financial services environment**, partnering deeply with engineering on system behavior, data flows, integration dependencies, and technical tradeoffs — built strong instincts for regulatory-consequence delivery and requirements quality at scale.
- **Served as internal subject-matter expert for an omni-channel communication product adopted across the full enterprise client base**, translating complex technical and compliance

capabilities into workflows non-technical buyers could operate without support.

Sr. Document Development Analyst · Broadridge Financial Solutions · Andover, MA · Jan 2006 – Jan 2014

- Built and maintained complex client-facing document and communication systems in a regulated financial services environment — the governance and requirements-rigor foundation the later deployment-leadership work was built on.

SKILLS AND FOCUS AREAS

Product Strategy: Product vision and 2–3 year roadmap, OKRs into focused product bets, 0→1 product building, prioritization and tradeoff decisions in ambiguous spaces, outcomes over output, mentoring junior PMs, recognized SME leadership, influence without authority across product / engineering / GTM, B2B SaaS

AI as Co-Builder: AI applied with intent where it adds real value, Claude Code prototyping, AI capability enablement at org scale, agentic workflows, AI-fluent product development, responsible / customer-centric AI judgment, Zero-Translation Building (framework originator)

Data & Experimentation: Opinionated analytics products, composite scoring and risk modeling, success-metric definition, hypothesis-driven development, experimentation-informed prioritization, qualitative-to-structured synthesis, KPI definition

Technical Credibility: APIs and system architecture, data flows and integration tradeoffs, deployment-model and platform product thinking, technical-systems fluency with engineering, requirements engineering, SQL

Tooling: Jira, Confluence, GitHub, SQL, Slack MCP, Claude Code CLI

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Management Information Systems and Management

Manning School of Business, UMass Lowell · 1999

WRITING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

The Unofficial Leader (Substack) · theunofficialleader.substack.com

Weekly publication on where AI actually earns its place, adoption realism, and what's happening beneath the surface of how teams work. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework. Active LinkedIn audience engagement on product, AI adoption, and team dynamics.